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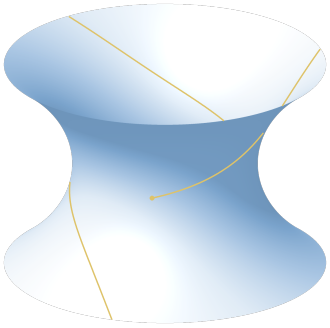
Federal Fraud Expansion
Working Document

Fraud investigation roadmap

Top ideas for the 33 largest agencies

Authored by:
Steve Taylor, Managing Partner: taylor@geodesic.pro

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$$\mathcal{G}(x) = x^x \qquad \nabla_{\dot\gamma}\dot\gamma = 0$$

We navigate our clients from a challenging problem to a defensible solution along the shortest rigorous path.

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Status: Draft v0.1 (2026-11-01), for Steve's review. **Builds on:** the top 33 ranking, the 33 agency briefs in docs/agencies/ and the review plan, whose weeks, waves and IDs (F1-F12, C1-C3, P1-P9) this roadmap follows. Public data only in Phase 1; every idea below produces leads for an Inspector General or DOJ, not public accusations.

1 Bottom line

We will run **86 investigation ideas across 33 agencies** in two phases, but they reduce to a small number of patterns the SBA work already detects: shell and front companies, shared identifiers across "separate" recipients, outlier billing or pricing, links to excluded parties, and payments to people who are dead or ineligible. That is why one shared pipeline can cover the whole government.

- **Start with ten investigations** (table below). They sit where the most fraud-prone money meets record-level public data: HHS hospice and home health, DoD set-aside fronts, SBA's non-pandemic loans, customs evasion, SNAP retailers and meal sponsors, DOT DBE fronts and SAM.gov shells.
- **Cover the other 26 agencies cheaply** through three shared screens (contractors C1, research awards C2, grantees C3), five contained pilots and aggregate screens where payee data is confidential.
- **Every agency gets a finding by 2027-02-26** (week 15): a ranked lead list or a reasoned "nothing actionable from public data", plus a Phase 2 data request.
- **Phase 2 turns leads into cases.** Internal claims, invoices and payment files, reached first through OIGs, move the work from risky entities to specific false claims. The biggest ideas are cross-agency: death data, shared bank accounts and identity reuse.

2 How to read the roadmap

Each idea has an ID (agency code and number, such as **HHS-1**) so later prototypes, memos and proposals can refer to it. "When" gives the Phase 1 weeks from the review plan (week 1 starts 2026-11-02; weeks skip 2026-12-21 to 2027-01-01). "Take to" names who receives the leads. The first idea listed for each agency is its first prototype from the brief.

Agencies are grouped by the review plan's workstreams: Wave 1 and Wave 2 deep dives (A1, A2), contained pilots (B), shared screens (C1-C3), data partners (E) and aggregate screens with access cases (D).

3 The ten investigations to start first

#	ID	Investigation	Scheme it targets	Weeks	Take to
1	HHS-1	Hospice and home health risk map, Los Angeles County and Minnesota	Sham and captive providers, owner networks	3-7	CMS CPI, HHS-OIG, DOJ Health Care Fraud Unit
2	DOD-1	Set-aside contractor integrity screen, FY2021-FY2026	Fronts and pass-throughs for ineligible firms	3-7	DCIS, DoD OIG



#	ID	Investigation	Scheme it targets	Weeks	Take to
3	SBA-1	SBA screens extended to 7(a), 504 and 8(a)	Identity and address reuse, lender and agent rings	3-6	SBA OIG
4	DHS-1	Tariff-evasion importer lead list, two product groups	Transshipment, false origin, shell importers	6-10	CBP Office of Trade, HSI, Trade Fraud Task Force
5	USDA-1	SNAP retailer risk map, two states	Trafficking fronts and owner reuse after disqualification	6-10	FNS Retailer Operations, USDA OIG
6	USDA-2	Child meal sponsor capacity screen, one state	Meals claimed beyond local children (Feeding Our Future pattern)	6-10	USDA OIG, state agencies
7	DOT-1	DBE front and bid rotation screen, three states	DBE fronts, complementary bidding	7-10	DOT OIG, Procurement Collusion Strike Force
8	GSA-1	SAM.gov registration integrity report, government-wide	Shell clusters, re-registration after exclusion	7-10	GSA IAE, GSA OIG
9	DOD-2	Bidder collusion networks by market	Shared control among "competitors", win rotation	4-7	Procurement Collusion Strike Force
10	FCC-1	E-Rate provider and consultant network map	Kickbacks and single-bid steering	8-11	FCC Enforcement Bureau and OIG, USAC

4 Investigation ideas by agency

Ranks (out of 33) are from top33.pdf.

4.1 Wave 1 and Wave 2 deep dives (weeks 3 to 10)

Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
HHS	**HHS-1** hospice and home health clusters: shared addresses and owners, billing ramp after enrollment, long stays and live discharges. **HHS-2** owner networks linked to LEIE exclusions, revoked and suspended providers. **HHS-3** national billing outliers in durable medical equipment, labs and telehealth. *Rank 1; weeks 3-7; take to CMS CPI, HHS-OIG, DOJ HCF Unit.*
DoD	**DOD-1** set-aside fronts: new firms with large awards, shared POCs with large firms, most work subcontracted to one ineligible firm. **DOD-2** collusion networks and win rotation. **DOD-3** sole-source awards just under thresholds and runaway modifications. *Rank 2; weeks 3-7; take to DCIS, DoD OIG, OSBP, PCSF.*
SBA	**SBA-1** pandemic fraud signals applied to 7(a) and 504. **SBA-2** lender and agent concentration of bad loans (shared with FDIC). **SBA-3** pandemic fraud owners now holding loans or 8(a), HUBZone or VetCert status. *Rank 3; weeks 3-6; take to SBA OIG, Office of Credit Risk Mgmt.*
DHS	**DHS-1** mirror trade gaps by product and country, then the importers behind them. **DHS-2** shell importers appearing after tariff changes. **DHS-3** FEMA contractors that are new, out of area or tied to excluded parties. *Rank 4; weeks 6-10; take to CBP, HSI, Trade Fraud Task Force, FEMA FIID.*



Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
USDA	**USDA-1** SNAP retailer clusters near disqualified stores. **USDA-2** CACFP and summer meal sponsors claiming beyond capacity. **USDA-3** farm disaster payments far above county peers. *Rank 4; weeks 6-10; take to FNS, USDA OIG, state agencies.*
DOT	**DOT-1** DBEs sharing identifiers with their prime or working for one prime only. **DOT-2** bid rotation from full state bid tabs. **DOT-3** DBE commitments at award that never appear in subaward reports. *Rank 6; weeks 7-10; take to DOT OIG, FHWA Civil Rights, PCSF.*
GSA	**GSA-1** SAM.gov shell clusters ranked by award dollars. **GSA-2** new UEIs tied to excluded entities. **GSA-3** schedule price, labor rate and lease outliers. *Rank 6; weeks 7-10; take to GSA IAE, FAS, GSA OIG.*

4.2 Contained pilots (weeks 7 to 11)

Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
FCC	**FCC-1** E-Rate consultant and provider networks with high single-bid share and high prices. **FCC-2** Lifeline and ACP enrollment beyond eligible households. **FCC-3** Rural Health Care rate outliers. *Rank 8; weeks 8-11; take to FCC EB and OIG, USAC.*
VA	**VA-1** SDVOSB fronts (the DoD screen on VA awards). **VA-2** GI Bill school watch list: enrollment growth, caution flags, owner links to closed schools. **VA-3** community care vendors on LEIE. *Rank 8; weeks 8-11; take to VA OSDBU, VBA Education, VA OIG.*
OPM	**OPM-1** providers excluded by HHS or SAM but missing from OPM's list. **OPM-2** deactivated or deceased NPIs still in carrier networks. **OPM-3** Medicare-flagged providers serving FEHB members. *Rank 11; weeks 8-10; take to OPM OIG, Healthcare and Insurance.*
Commerce	**DOC-1** BEAD-funded locations already shown as served. **DOC-2** subgrantees with USF enforcement history or no network history. **DOC-3** cost per location outliers. Framed as prevention before money goes out. *Rank 11; weeks 9-11; take to NTIA, Commerce OIG, state broadband offices.*
PBGC	**PBGC-1** SFA applications whose participant and death counts differ from Form 5500 history (known case: Central States, $127M, 3,479 deceased participants). **PBGC-2** payees with no sign of life (with SSA). *Rank 24; weeks 9-11; take to PBGC OIG, Multiemployer Program, EBSA.*

4.3 Shared screens (weeks 9 to 13)

C1 contractor screen runs the DoD code on other agencies' awards. **C2 research award screen** finds near-duplicate awards across SBIR.gov, NSF, NIH, NASA and PCORI (GAO found 842 high-risk awardees and about $445M possibly duplicative). **C3 grantee screen** joins grants and subawards to SAM.gov, Form 990 and the watch lists.

Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
Energy	**DOE-1** duplicate SBIR/STTR awards. **DOE-2** thin new recipients of large infrastructure and IRA grants. **DOE-3** Loan Programs Office borrowers tied to excluded parties. *Rank 11; C1 and C2 screens, weeks 9-12; take to DOE OIG.*
USACE	**USACE-1** set-aside fronts by district. **USACE-2** bid rotation in dredging and other published bids. **USACE-3** change-order growth versus peer projects. *Rank 14; C1 screen, weeks 9-11; take to Army CID MPFU, PCSF.*
EPA	**EPA-1** new nonprofits with large GGRF and Solar for All awards (facts only, given the litigation). **EPA-2** subgrant chains with shared officers. **EPA-3** contractor screen on revolving-fund construction. *Rank 15; C3 screen, weeks 10-13; take to EPA OIG, Grants and Debarment.*



Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
HUD	**HUD-1** owner networks with poor inspections and continuing payments. **HUD-2** CDBG-DR subrecipients and contractors. **HUD-3** subsidy cost per unit outliers. *Rank 16; C3 screen, weeks 10-13; take to HUD OIG, Multifamily Housing.*
State	**STATE-1** implementing-partner concentration in the ten largest aid countries. **STATE-2** partners linked to OFAC, UN or World Bank lists. **STATE-3** overhead and unit cost outliers; embassy construction contracts. *Rank 16; C1 and C3 screens, weeks 10-13; take to State OIG, Foreign Assistance.*
NASA	**NASA-1** duplicate SBIR awards. **NASA-2** award mills (many Phase I, no Phase II). **NASA-3** suppliers under large primes tied to excluded parties. *Rank 16; C1 and C2 screens, weeks 9-12; take to NASA OIG.*
NSF	**NSF-1** test bed for the duplicate-award method. **NSF-2** award mills and repeat PIs. **NSF-3** links to excluded parties and settled cases. *Rank 16; C2 screen, weeks 9-12; take to NSF OIG.*
Justice	**DOJ-1** case library from press releases, the label set for every screen (week 6). **DOJ-2** OJP, OVW and COPS subgrantee risk. **DOJ-3** prison commissary, medical and telecom price outliers. *Rank 20; data partner (E) and C3 screen, weeks 2-13; take to Fraud Section, Civil (FCA), DOJ OIG.*
SEC	**SEC-1** EDGAR officers and Form D issuers added to the entity spine to reveal common control. **SEC-2** award recipients run by people barred or charged by SEC or FINRA. *Rank 21; data partner (E), weeks 5-8; take to SEC Enforcement (data partner).*
USAID	**USAID-1** terminated awards with obligations far above outlays (unreturned advances). **USAID-2** partners with OIG findings now funded by State. *Rank 24; C3 screen, weeks 11-12; take to State and USAID OIG.*
DFC	**DFC-1** borrowers and sponsors matched to sanctions, exclusions and offshore leaks. **DFC-2** shared owners across "separate" projects. *Rank 29; C3 screen, week 12; take to DFC OIG.*
AmeriCorps	**CNCS-1** Foster Grandparent and State and National grantees with prior findings or high cost per member. **CNCS-2** Form 990 revenue checks. *Rank 30; C3 screen, week 12; take to AmeriCorps OIG.*
PCORTF	**PCOR-1** PCORI awards in the duplicate-award screen against NIH and NSF. **PCOR-2** awardees on LEIE or SAM exclusions. *Rank 31; C2 screen, week 12; take to PCORI, HHS-OIG.*
NRC	**NRC-1** suppliers in Part 21 defect reports and enforcement actions matched to contractor records. *Rank 31; C1 screen, week 13; take to NRC OI, NRC OIG.*
EOP	**EOP-1** grantee screen on ONDCP HIDTA grants. EOP's main role is audience: the Phase 1 report is written for OMB. *Rank 33; C3 screen, week 13; take to OMB OFFM.*

4.4 Aggregate screens and access cases (weeks 10 to 14)

These agencies pay individuals whose records are confidential, so public data points to places, intermediaries and programs. Each ends with a Phase 2 access proposal.

Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
Treasury	**TREAS-1** EITC and ACTC hot spots by ZIP from IRS SOI data. **TREAS-2** ERC and EITC promoter networks from charged cases. **TREAS-3** PPP borrowers in ERC cases, to size double dipping. *Rank 8; weeks 10-13; take to IRS-CI, TIGTA, Payment Integrity.*
SSA	**SSA-1** county SSI and disability outliers adjusted for age and health. **SSA-2** facilitator networks of attorneys, doctors and payees across charged cases. **SSA-3** the death-data case, sized from OPM and PBGC findings. *Rank 22; weeks 10-13; take to SSA OIG, Anti-Fraud Programs, Do Not Pay.*



Agency	Investigation ideas, and who receives the leads
Education	**ED-1** ghost student risk by college: aid growth with falling completion. **ED-2** schools on cash monitoring or tied to closed schools. *Rank 22; weeks 11-13; take to FSA Enforcement, ED OIG.*
Labor	**DOL-1** state UI claims versus local job loss and overpayment peers. **DOL-2** rules states can run, drawn from charged UI cases. **DOL-3** union filings for embezzlement signals. *Rank 26; weeks 11-14; take to DOL OIG, ETA, states.*
FDIC	**FDIC-1** PPP lender and fintech partner risk table. **FDIC-2** pre-failure signals for banks that failed 2019-2026. *Rank 27; weeks 10-11; take to FDIC OIG, RMS.*
Interior	**DOI-1** royalty per unit outliers by company and basin. **DOI-2** C1 screen on wildfire and land management contracts. *Rank 27; weeks 12-14; take to ONRR, DOI OIG.*

5 Phase 2: what internal data adds

Phase 1 leads open the door to internal data, starting with OIGs (two to four months to data, against six to twelve for matching agreements). The six first access proposals go out in week 8 (2027-01-08, P2); Treasury, SSA and DOL follow on 2027-02-12 (P4).

ID	Cross-agency investigation	Internal data	Lead agencies	Target
X-1	Payments to dead people in FEHB, PBGC, Medicare, VA and SNAP	SSA full death file	SSA, Treasury Do Not Pay	Late 2027
X-2	One bank account paid for many unrelated identities or firms	Payment file account numbers	Treasury Fiscal Service	2028
X-3	One identity or device behind UI, SNAP, Medicaid, SBA and aid claims	Application identity, device and IP data	DOL, USDA, HHS, SBA, ED via states	Mid 2028
X-4	Hidden common control across grants, contracts, loans and benefits	Payee TINs, owners, bank accounts	Treasury, GSA, OMB	2028
X-5	Payments to excluded parties in any program	Claims and payments matched to all exclusion lists	HHS, OPM, VA, GSA	Late 2027
X-6	Benefits paid to prisoners	BOP and state prison data	DOJ, SSA, DOL, USDA	2028

The first internal-data pilots rerun Phase 1 ideas on transactions: **HHS-1** on Medicare claims, **DOD-1** on invoices or **SBA-1** on loan applications. First agreements by 2027-06, first pilot live by 2027-07-30 (P9), first prosecutor-ready case package by 2027-10.

6 Milestones

Date	Milestone
2026-11-06	FOIA requests filed (F10); repo layout and data pull log (F2)
2026-11-27	Shared foundation done: entity spine, watch lists, scoring, lead package template (F3-F9)
2026-12-11	DOJ case library v1 with 2,000+ tagged cases (F5)
2026-12-18	Wave 1 results: HHS-1, DOD-1/2, SBA-1 lead lists and memos
2027-01-08	Six Phase 2 access proposals sent (P2)
2027-01-22	Wave 2 results: DHS, USDA, DOT, GSA

Date	Milestone
2027-01-29	Pilot results: FCC, OPM, VA, Commerce, PBGC
2027-02-12	Shared screen results (C1-C3); Treasury, SSA, DOL proposals (P4)
2027-02-26	Review memos for all 33; first referral packages after counsel review
2027-03-05	Phase 1 report and leadership briefing; Phase 2 go/no-go (P6)

7 Risks and decisions

- **Validation can fail.** Each screen must meet the bar in the review plan (known cases five times more common in its top 5%) before its leads are used; misses are reported, not hidden.
- **Public data lags** one to two years and hides the claim itself, so Phase 1 finds risky entities, not proven fraud.
- **Agreements are the long pole.** If no OIG signs by mid-2027, Phase 2 slips; that is why proposals go out in week 8.
- **Decisions for Steve** are unchanged from the review plan: start date and team, agency order, commercial data (manifests and corporate registries), referral route (OIGs and DOJ only, or False Claims Act filings too), and OIGs versus program offices as first Phase 2 partners.